

Assignment-4

1) How do you use the Today and Now functions in Excel.

In excel, Today and now are volatile date and time functions meaning they update automatically whenever the worksheet is recalculated.

→ Today() function:-

Purposes:- Returns the current system date.

* It does not show time, only the date.

Syntax:- Today()

Ex:- Today() :- It is showing today day.

Now():-

* It returns the current system date and current time.

* Time is shown in hours, minutes and seconds.

Syntax:- Now()

Ex:- Now() :- It is showing on current date and time.

2) what is the difference b/w date and text functions in excel.

The date and text functions are both used while working with dates, but their purpose and output are completely different.

date function:-

* It creates a valid date value by combining year, month and day.

* This result is a date (number format) not text.

* excel can use this date for calculation.

syntax:-

=date(year, month, day)

Ex: =date(2026, 1, 22)

Result: 22-01-2026

use of date():-

* creating dates from separate columns (year, month, day)

* Avoiding date errors

* calculating age, tenure, deadlines

* used in formulas like workday, fmonth, networkday.

Text function:-

* It converts the no. of date into text in a specific format.

* Output is text, so it cannot be used for calculations.

3) How would you calculate the difference b/w two dates in excel.

In excel, the difference b/w the two dates can be calculated in multiple ways, depending on whether you want the result in days, months or years.

Method 1: Simple date subtraction.

→ Excel stores dates as serial numbers, so you can subtract them directly.

Formula: = end-date - start-date

Ex:- $A_1 = 01-01-2026$

$B_1 = 22-01-2026$

$= B_1 - A_1$

Result:- 21 days

Use-cases:

→ finding no. of days b/w two dates.
→ attendance & billing calculations.

Method 2: using the datedif function.

* datedif calculates the difference in days, months or years.

* This function is very useful for age calculation.

Syntax:

= datedif (start-date, end-date, unit)

Ex:- • days

= datedif (A1, B1, "d")

• months = datedif (A1, B1, "m")

4) Explain how the EOMONTH function is used in excel.

- * Returns the ending date (last date) of a month.
- * very useful in accounting, payroll, billing and reporting

Syntax:

=EOMONTH(start_date, months)

Arguments:

- * start_date → any valid date
- * Months → no. of months before or after the start date.

start_date:

- 0 → same month
- 1 → next month
- 1 → Previous month.

Ex: 1) Last day of the same month:-

=EOMONTH("15-01-2026", 0)

Result:- 31-01-2026

2) Last day of next month

=EOMONTH("15-01-2026", 1)

Result:- 28-02-2026

3) Last day of previous month

=EOMONTH("15-01-2026", -1)

5) How can you extract the day, month and year from a date using excel function?

Excel provides separate built-in function to extract the day, month and year from a given date.

* These functions are very useful in data analysis, reports and calculations.

* Given date example:

assume cell A1 = 22-01-2026

* Extract day using day()

Purpose:- Returns the day function number from a date

Formula:- =day(A1)

Result:- 22

use case:-

* Attendance tracking

* Daily reports

* Extract month using month()

Purpose:- It returns the month number (1-12)

Formula:-

=month(A1)

Result:- 1

use case:-

* monthly analysis

* Grouping data by month

Formula!

=year (A1)

→ Result :- 2026

* Extract month name :- to get monthname instead of number.

Formula! - Text (A1, "mmmm")

Result! :- January.

* Extract day name! - To get dayname instead of number.

Formula! - (A1 "dddd")

Result! :- Thursday.

6) What is the purpose of the workday function, and how is it used?

The workday function in excel is used to calculate a future or past working date by excluding weekdays and specified holidays. It is mainly used in project planning, HR and business scheduling. Purpose of workday:

* Finds a date after adding or subtracting working days.

* Excludes Saturdays and Sundays.

Syntax! :-

=workday (start-date, days [holidays])

5 Assignments:

- c *start_date $\rightarrow$ starting_date
- d days $\rightarrow$ no. of working days
- f positive $\rightarrow$ future date
- Negative $\rightarrow$ past date
- *holidays (optional) $\rightarrow$ Range of holiday dates.

Ex:-

=workday("22-01-2026", 10)

*Returns the date after 10 working days, skipping weekends.

7) How do you create a linear growth series using fill series in excel

(A) A Linear growth series in excel means a sequence of numbers that increase or decrease by a constant value. Excel's fill series feature makes this very easy.

What is linear growth series?

*A series where each value increases by a fixed amount.

Ex:- 10, 20, 30, 40, 50

Common difference = +10

Method 1:- Using the fill handle.

$\rightarrow$ Enter the first value in a cell (ex:- 10)

$\rightarrow$ Enter the second value that defines the pattern (ex:- 20)

* select the fill handle downward or sideways.

* Excel automatically continues the linear pattern.

Result:- 10, 20, 30, 40, 50

Method 2:- using the fill series command

→ enter the starting values in a cell

→ select the cell

→ Go to home → fill → series

→ choose.

→ series in :- Rows or columns

→ Type: linear.

→ step value :- Difference b/w values.

→ stop value :- last value.

→ click ok.

Uses of linear Growth series:-

* Generating serial numbers

* Creating timelines

* Monthly or yearly data

* Salary or sales increments.

* Mathematical sequences.

- * select both cells.
 - * Drag the fill handle downward & sideways.
 - * Excel automatically continues the linear pattern.
- Result:- 10, 20, 30, 40, 50

Method 2:- using the fill series command

- enter the starting values in a cell
- select the cell
- Go to home → fill → series
- choose.
- series in :- Rows or columns
- Type: Linear.
- step value :- Difference b/w values.
- stop value :- last value.
- click ok.

Use of Linear Growth series:-

- * Generating serial numbers
- * Creating timelines
- * Monthly or yearly data
- * Salary or sales increments.
- * Mathematical sequences.

8) What are the different options available in the autofill feature in excel.

The autofill feature in excel is used to automatically fill data into adjacent cells by continuing a pattern based on existing values when you drag the fill handle. excel provides several autofill options.

Main autofill options:-

- * copy cells: copies the exact same value or formulas to other cells.

- * No pattern is applied.

Ex:- 5 → 5 → 5 → 5.

Fill series:-

- * Continues a numeric (or) data sequence.

- * can be linear (1, 2, 3) or based on a step value.

Ex:- 10, 20 ⇒ 30, 40

Fill formatting only:-

- * copies only the cells formatting, not the value or formulas.

- * useful when you want consistent formatting.

9) How can you create a custom list for auto-fill in excel.

A custom list in excel allows you to define your own sequence of values so that excel can automatically fill them using the auto-fill feature. This is useful when working with repeated text patterns.

* A user defined sequence of values

* Used by autofill to continue a pattern.

Ex:-

low → medium → high

HR → finance → IT → admin

Steps to create a custom list:

1. Click on file
2. Select options
3. Choose advanced
4. Scroll down to general
5. Click edit custom lists.
6. Enter your list values. Ex:- low
medium
high

7. Click add

8. Click ok

Using the custom list:-

→ Type the first item of the list in a cell.

→ Drag the fill handle.

10) Describe a situation where you would use the Networkdays function.

The networkdays function in excel is used to calculate the no. of working days b/w two dates, excluding weekends and optional holidays. It is commonly used in business, HR and project management scenarios.

- counts only work days
- Automatically excludes weekends
- It can exclude holiday dates if provided.

Syntax:-

=networkdays (start-date, end-date, [holidays])

Situation:-

*Salary or payroll calculation

To calculate the no. of working days in a month for salary processing.

⇒ Excludes weekends and public holidays

Ex:-
=networkdays ("01-01-2026", "31-01-2026", A1:A5)

(where A1:A5 contains holiday dates)